Photosynthesis is the process by which plants use the energy of sunlight to make food. It takes place in the chloroplasts, small structures inside plant cells. Chloroplasts contain chlorophyll, a green pigment that absorbs light energy. During photosynthesis, plants take in carbon dioxide from the air and water from the soil. Using light energy, they convert the carbon dioxide and water into glucose, a sugar that stores chemical energy. Oxygen is released as a by-product. Animals depend on photosynthesis too, because they eat plants or eat other animals that eat plants. Without photosynthesis, there would be almost no oxygen in the air and very little food on Earth.